

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

3D Studio

We give you absolute gems from the 3DS Max roster of jargon to help you get your friends to drop their jaws when they meet you next.

Space Warp

This one takes the literal meaning of space warp—it warps space within physical objects in a controlled fashion. The commonest “warps” are ripples in a rectangular surface, a sphere exploding, etc.

Jaw-dropper My boss is worse than a mailer daemon; tells me to finish projects on Monday, even if he gives them to me on Tuesday. The next time he annoys me I will space warp his face, and nuke his GS on the side.

Con Meter 6/10

Gizmo

Traditionally, something your rich friend possessed, and something you always wanted. In 3DSMax, a Gizmo controls the modification of an object. It allows you to visualise the modification. If you bend a Bend modifier Gizmo, for instance, the object bends too.

Jaw-dropper This new personal trainer of mine, who I am paying Rs 1,500 per workout session, thinks he has access to my Modifier Gizmo. He makes me stretch and bend beyond limit!

Sometimes, I wonder why I am paying him to torture me. But give me a few months, and I will sack him. Then let's see who controls his Modifier Gizmo.

Con Meter 6/10

Mental ray

No relation to Satyajit Ray! In 3DS Max, a Mental Ray is a cool tool that allows physically correct simulations of light reflections and refractions producing life like effects such as concentrated light reflection through water surface and realistic global reflection effects. Confused? Wait until you use it on your unsuspecting friends.

Jaw-dropper Sorry I got late for the party. My new Mental Ray draws out such great scenes that sometime I really get lost in them. Oh, the stuff it does. I wonder whether it is me or just my Mental Ray.

Con Meter 8/10

A Redesign Riot

The House of Digit often plays host to Chaos. It visits during issue-closing night, sits at the back, plays bad music, spews corny jokes and come morning is ceremoniously thrown out kicking and screaming. As an irritating but tolerated mascot, Chaos is par for the course. This issue it overextended the visit. Occasion: The Digit Redesign.

The meetings weren't the 20-odd minute fests of ideas, but mutants weaned on 90 MB PowerPoint files, which charted the redesign course, mutants that feasted on the brain-dump of a million editors. Give or take. Thus fed, these beasts boasted of a minimum five-hour half-life. Writers, editors and designers emerged with groggy eyes, and a burning desire to see their loved ones, pronto!

This is not to say, we didn't have our fun—we persevered when we had to and had our small doses of entertainment while no one

was looking. So, shush, don't tell but: *Counter Strike—Condition Zero* is a splendid game indeed, table tennis can be tiring when played for three hours non-stop, PopCap's *Zuma* is addictive, *Lakshya* sucks, and DVDs have too much space, if you ask us.

We worked, we played, Chaos danced in glee. Someone described the scene as “the entropy of the universe, packed in one office”... There were new section-names to learn, new layouts to follow and much to everyone's chagrin, a lot more software to be tested for the DVD.

We did it though.

Now, for the first time in two months, the office is quiet as the rat-a-tat of keyboards ceases and the dust settles down. Everyone's tired; weeks of 16-hour days will do that. Even the veteran writers now proudly exhibit callused fingertips like battle scars. It is 3 in the morning, time to head home to estranged families. Hope you enjoy our labour of love. Happy reading!



DIGIT DIARY



statement that comes from a company known for the security-through-obscure approach to its products and customers. “Windows has opened up opportunities for computers and chips to be built in Asia.”

Which is true, but most of that software is pirated, which brings us to: the loss of tax revenue for governments Bill ascribed to, “when people don't pay for software.” As in pirated copies of Windows, Mr Gates?

He also pointed out that software piracy is on the decline in Asia. What he failed to mention however is the fact that Microsoft is now selling a ‘Lite’ version of Windows XP in Thailand and Malaysia—light on the wallet—something which wouldn't have been possible if Linux was not gaining popularity in those markets. Competition, good.

Perhaps next time, Bill Gates would deem us intelligent enough to address real concerns on Open Source and its progeny, until then, thanks for the laughs!

FERTILE IMAGINATION

Calling all sperm

That irritating ringtone could be ringing in news more dire than a missed meeting. Carrying a mobile phone in your trouser or jeans pocket could cut sperm count by nearly 30 per cent. This news came from a Hungarian study conducted by the department of obstetrics and gynaecology at the University of Szeged.

“The prolonged use of cell phones may have a



negative effect on sperm production and male fertility,” said Dr Imre Fejes. Fejes and his team analysed sperm from 221 men and questioned them about